

ROME

1. Space and historical evolution: The Monarchy

1.1 The territory of the Italian peninsula

- **Geography:** Mountainous territory between the **Alps** (north) and the **Apennines** (runs from north to south).
- **Peoples (8th century BC):**
 - North: Celts and Ligurians.
 - Center: **Etruscans** and Latins.
 - South: Greeks (**Magna Graecia**).

1.2 Foundation of Rome and Stages

- **Foundation (753 BC):** Latin tribes near the **seven hills** and the mouth of the **Tiber River** .
 - **Advantages:** Easy defense and control of trade routes (north-south crossing).
- **Stages of its history:**
 - **Monarchy** (753-509 BC).
 - **Republic** (509-27 BC).
 - **Empire** (27 BC-476 AD).

1.3 The Monarchy (753-509 BC)

- **Political system:** King with absolute power + **Senate** (council of rich families).
- **Society:**
 - **Patricians:** Wealthy/powerful families, descendants of founders. They have rights.
 - **Plebeians:** The rest of the population. They pay taxes and serve in the army, but have no political rights.
- **Etruscan domination:** The last 3 kings were Etruscan. Rome grows and prospers.
- **End of the Monarchy:** Popular revolt in **509 BC** against **Tarquin the Proud** . Expulsion of the king and beginning of the **Republic** .

2. The Republic (509-27 BC)

2.1 The Republican Government

Power was divided among three institutions (without salaries, which favored the rich):

- **Elections (Popular Assemblies):** Formed by citizens. They approve laws and elect magistrates.
- **Magistrates:** They govern for one year. The most important are the **Consuls** (they lead the army and preside over the Senate).
- **Senate:** 300 former magistrates. They controlled foreign policy and warfare. In practice, they made all the key decisions.

2.2 Social conflicts: Patricians vs. Plebeians.

A struggle of over 200 years by the common people to obtain rights. Main achievements:

- **Tribunes of the plebs (494 BC):** New magistrates who defended their interests.
- **Law of the Twelve Tables (451 BC):** First compilation of written laws to prevent abuses.
- **Access to power:** Right to appoint consuls (367 BC) and access to magistracies.

2.3 Territorial expansion

Rome becomes a power thanks to its organized army:

- **Italian Peninsula (4th-3rd century BC):** They defeat Gauls, Latins and southern Greeks.
- **Western Mediterranean (3rd-2nd centuries BC):** Defeat of Carthage in the **Punic Wars**.
- **Eastern Mediterranean (2nd century BC-2nd century AD):** Conquest of Macedonia, Greece and Syria.

2.4 Consequences of the Conquests

The conquests profoundly transformed Rome:

- **Economic:** Arrival of great wealth, new lands, and numerous slaves.
- **Political:** Crisis due to corruption and abuse of power by some rulers.
- **Social:** Ruin for small farmers and concentration of land in the hands of generals and elites.
- **Conflicts:** Peasant and slave revolts, harshly repressed.
- **Change of regime:** Dictators with absolute power, such as Julius Caesar.
- **End of the Republic:** After the assassination of Julius Caesar and several civil wars, Octavian Augustus established the Empire in 27 BC.

3. The Empire (27 BC - 476 AD)

3.1 The new system of government

- **Absolute power:** The emperor (from Octavian Augustus onwards) concentrates political, military, legislative and religious powers.
- **Institutions:** The Senate and the elections are maintained, but their power is **theoretical** (they are under the control of the emperor).
- **Administration:** The Empire is divided into **provinces** that pay taxes to Rome.
- **Maximum extent:** Reached under Emperor **Trajan** (98-117 AD).

3.2 "Pax Romana" and Romanization (1st and 2nd centuries AD)

- **Pax Romana:** Period of tranquility and economic, cultural and urban prosperity.
- **Romanization:** The process by which conquered peoples adopt the culture and organization of Rome.
- **Agents of Romanization:**
 - **Army:** Direct contact with indigenous people.
 - **Cities:** Spread of the Roman lifestyle.
 - **Latin:** Common language for the entire empire.
 - **Rulers and Causeways:** Political, military, and commercial control.

3.3 The crisis of the third century and the end of the Empire

Causes of the decline:

- **Policies:** Instability, civil wars, and military indiscipline.
- **External:** Attacks by **Germanic peoples** on the borders.
- **Economic:** Fewer conquests = fewer slaves and less wealth. Increased taxes and abandonment of cities for the countryside.

The final division:

- **395 AD:** Emperor **Theodosius I** divides the empire to better defend it:
 - **West:** Capital in Rome.
 - **East:** Capital in Constantinople.
- **End of the West (476 AD):** The Germanic tribes dethrone the last emperor, **Romulus Augustulus**.

4. Economic activities

4.1 Agriculture and land ownership

- **Basis of the economy:** Mediterranean triad (cereals, vine, olive) + fruits and vegetables.
- **Technical innovations:**
 - Improvement of irrigation (reservoirs and irrigation ditches).
 - **Roman plow** (iron share), fallow land, water mills and presses.
- **Property types:**
 - **Large estates:** Vast tracts of land owned by the wealthy. Center: **Rural village**. Use of slaves.
 - **Small property:** Worked by families to subsist.

4.2 Mining and Crafts

- **Mining:** State-owned (gold, silver, iron, salt...). Advanced techniques: waterwheels, pulleys, and drainage systems.
- **Crafts:** Great technical perfection (glass, ceramics, weapons, ships).
 - **Workshops:** Small (grouped in a **college**) or large workshops with slaves.

4.3 Trade

- **Success factors:** Common currency (**denarius, sestertius, as**), control of the Mediterranean and road network.
- **Routes:** Intense domestic and foreign trade by sea, river and land.

5. Society and civic life

5.1 Social groups

After equality between patricians and plebeians, society became divided by rights:

- **Citizens:** They had political rights (voting) and civil rights (property and marriage).
 - **Wealthy minority:** Senators, magistrates, and military personnel.
 - **Humble majority:** Rural and urban plebs.

- **Non-citizens:** Without rights. This included **free women** , **freedmen** (freed slaves), and **slaves** .

5.2 The Roman city

They were political and economic centers. Their design imitated military camps:

- **Layout:** Two main streets: **Cardo** (north-south) and **Decumanus** (east-west).
- **Forum:** Public square at the intersection of both streets. Heart of the city.
 - It contained the **Temple** , the **Curia** (Senate) and the **Basilica** (Justice).
- **Services:** Aqueducts (water), sewage and leisure buildings (theater, amphitheater and circus).

5.3 The urban way of life

- **Morning:** Start before sunrise. The wealthy attended to "clients" and business; the rest went to work.
- **Women:** Mostly engaged in domestic tasks, although some were artisans or entrepreneurs.
- **Afternoon:** Rest at the "**sixth**" hour (noon).
 - Upper classes: Leisure at the **thermal baths** .
 - Shows: Theatre, circus and combat (free on holidays).
- **Dinner:** The most important meal of the day upon returning home.

6. Roman Religion and Culture

6.1 The gods and religion

- **Official Religion (Polytheistic):** They assimilated gods from other peoples.
 - **Greek Gods:** Adopted with Roman names (Jupiter, Juno, etc.).
 - **Emperor Cult:** The only mandatory cult to maintain the unity of the Empire.
- **Private Religion (Home):**
 - **Manes:** Spirits of the ancestors.
 - **Lares:** Protectors of the home.
 - **Penates:** Guardians of the pantry.

6.2 Christianity

- **Origin:** Palestine (time of Jesus). Message: monotheism, equality, and love of neighbor.
- **Evolution in the Empire:**
 - **Persecutions:** Especially under Diocletian (rejection of the imperial cult). Use of **catacombs** (underground cemeteries).
 - **Edict of Milan (313 AD):** Constantine proclaims religious freedom. The first **basilicas are built** .
 - **Edict of Thessalonica (380 AD):** Theodosius I makes it the **official religion** .

6.3 Roman culture

Fundamental contributions to posterity:

- **Latin:** The official language from which the current Romance languages are derived.

- **Law:** Written laws to regulate public and private life. The basis of modern justice.
- **Great figures:**
 - **Philosophy:** Seneca.
 - **Literature:** Virgil.
 - **History:** Julius Caesar and Livy.
 - **Medicine:** Galen.

7. Roman art: Architecture

7.1 Main features

- **Practical purpose:** The buildings had to be useful to the population.
- **Materials:** Stone, marble, brick and **cement** (mixture of lime, stones and sand), which allowed for very resistant walls.
- **Supports:** * Greek orders + two new ones: **Tuscan** (Doric with base) and **Composite** (mixture of Ionic and Corinthian).
- **Roofs:** They used flat roofs (architraved) and, above all, **arches, vaults and domes**.

7.2 Religious and civil buildings

- **Religious (Temples):** * **Rectangular:** Similar to the Greek ones, but with a staircase only on the front and attached columns (e.g., *Maison Carrée*).
 - **Circular:** The most famous is the **Pantheon in Rome** with its large dome.
- **Civilians and entertainment:**
 - **Basilicas:** Justice and commerce.
 - **Thermal baths:** Public baths and social gathering place.
 - **Leisure:** Theatres, **Amphitheatres** (gladiators) and **Circuses** (chariot races).
- **Engineering:** Roads, bridges and **aqueducts** (water transport).
- **Commemorative monuments:** Columns and **triumphal arches** to remember victories.

8. Roman art: Sculpture, painting and mosaic

8.1 Sculpture: Realism and Propaganda

- **Inspiration:** Based on Greek art, but much more **realistic**.
- **The Portrait:**
 - **Republic:** Maximum realism (based on wax masks of the deceased).
 - **Empire:** The image of the emperor is idealized to show his power.
 - **Types:** Standing statues, busts and **equestrian portraits** (on horseback).
- **Historical Relief:** Sculptures on walls to narrate battles and ceremonies. Their function was to **promote** the greatness of Rome (e.g., Trajan's Column).

8.2 Painting and Mosaic

- **Mural:**
 - It was done **in fresco** (on a damp wall) with bright colors.
 - Themes: Landscapes, mythology, everyday scenes, and fake architecture.
 - **Pompeii and Herculaneum:** Cities with the best preserved paintings thanks to the volcanic ash.
- **The Mosaic:**
 - They mainly decorated the **floors** of wealthy homes.
 - Made with **tesserae** (small colored pieces).

9. The Germanic peoples: The end of an era

9.1 Origin and expansion

- **Who were they?:** Called "barbarians" by Rome. They came from the north (Denmark and Scandinavia).
- **Society:** They lived in the countryside (livestock farmers and metalworkers), organized in family clans.
- **Religion:** They worshipped warrior gods like **Odin** .
- **The entrance to the Empire:** * Driven by the **Huns** , they crossed the Rhine and Danube borders.
 - They entered by force or through pacts (lands in exchange for defense).
 - In the **5th century** , they formed independent kingdoms (Franks in Gaul, Visigoths in Hispania).

9.2 The Germanic kingdoms and ruralization

- **Government:** Monarchies where the king relies on trusted men (loyalty in exchange for land).
- **Self-sufficient economy:** Large-scale agriculture is the foundation. They produce everything they need due to the lack of trade.
- **Abandonment of cities:** Cities lose population. People flee to the countryside seeking the protection of wealthy landowners. Large **landowners** become the dominant group.

9.3 Religion, culture and art

- **Religion:** They went from paganism to **Arianism** (a variant of Christianity) and, finally, to **Catholicism** .
- **Architecture and Sculpture:** Great decline. The construction of large buildings ceased, and sculpture became crude and primitive.
- **Goldsmithing:** Their strong point. Great mastery in metalwork, colorful jewelry with stones and enamels.

QUESTIONS

1.1 The territory of the Italian peninsula

How did the topography of the Italian peninsula influence the peoples who inhabited it?

1.2 Founding of Rome and stages

Why was the location where Rome was founded favorable for its growth?

1.3 The Monarchy (753–509 BC)

How was Roman society organized during the Monarchy?

2.1 The Republican Government

How was political power distributed during the Roman Republic?

2.2 Social conflicts: patricians and plebeians

What did the plebeians achieve after their struggle against the patricians?

2.3 Territorial expansion

Why was the army key to Rome's expansion?

2.4 Consequences of the conquests

What social changes did the Roman conquests bring about?

3.1 The new system of government

What differences were there between the power of the emperor and that of the republican magistrates?

3.2 Pax Romana and Romanization

What does Romanization mean and how did it spread?

3.3 The crisis of the third century and the end of the Empire

What were the main causes of the crisis of the Roman Empire?

4.1 Agriculture and land ownership

Why was agriculture the foundation of the Roman economy?

4.2 Mining and crafts

Why were mining and crafts important to Rome?

4.3 Trade

What factors facilitated the development of Roman trade?

5.1 Social groups

How was Roman society organized according to the rights of individuals?

5.2 The Roman city

What functions did the forum have within a Roman city?

5.3 The urban way of life

What was daily life like in a Roman city?

6.1 The gods and religion

What were the differences between the official religion and domestic religion in Rome?

6.2 Christianity

How did the situation of Christianity change within the Roman Empire?

6.3 Roman culture

What Roman cultural contribution do you consider most important? Explain why.

7.1 Main characteristics of Roman architecture

Why is Roman architecture considered practical?

7.2 Religious and civil buildings

What purpose did the baths serve in Roman society?

8.1 Sculpture: Realism and Propaganda

How was sculpture used to display power in Rome?

8.2 Painting and mosaic

What were mosaics used for in Roman houses?

9.1 Origin and expansion of the Germanic peoples

Why did the Germanic peoples enter the Roman Empire?

9.2 The Germanic kingdoms and ruralization

How did life in cities change after the arrival of the Germanic peoples?

9.3 Germanic religion, culture and art

How did the religion of the Germanic peoples evolve after their contact with Rome?